

OPEN THE SUIT THAT BUYS YOU A REBID

Usually you open your longest suit. But first ask: after I open, what will I REBID?

When you are minimum (about 11-15) you cannot introduce a higher-ranking second suit at the two level -- that shows extra strength you do not have. So when opening your long suit leaves you no cheap rebid, open a DIFFERENT suit instead.

- 5 clubs and 4 diamonds: open 1♦, not 1♣. Over partner's major you rebid 2♣, showing

both minors. Open 1♣ and your only way to show diamonds is 2♦ -- a higher-ranking suit at the two level, promising more than you have.

- 6 of a minor and 5 of a major (6♣-5♥, 6♣-5♠, 6♦-5♥, 6♦-5♠): open the 5-card MAJOR,

then rebid your long minor cheaply. Open the 6-card minor and showing the major means bidding it at the two level -- higher-ranking, more than you have.

- Both minors 5-5: open the higher, 1♦, then rebid 2♣.

Sometimes the ordinary rule already works: with 5 diamonds and 4 clubs, open your longest, 1♦, and 2♣ is cheap anyway. The skill is spotting when opening your longest suit would leave you stuck.

Reference: <https://www.advinbridge.com/this-week-in-bridge/637>